

Winkles Has Unique 'Recruiting' Problems

(Another in a series of High and Inside guest columns written for the vacationing LeRoy Bearman)

By BOBBY WINKLES, ASU Baseball Coach

Three national baseball titles in six years has given me one new "benefit"—writer's cramp.

I've averaged 3000 letters a year from high school or junior college players wishing to attend Arizona State University, naturally most on a scholarship.

Which brings me to a "problem" I hope I always am fortunate enough to have—how to fill six scholarships I get each year (for a total of 24 for a four year period).

Right now we can be very selective but it's a struggle what with the pro draft of high school seniors. Right now

San Antonio, who came on a basketball scholarship.

He became team captain and the regular shortstop while playing on two NCAA championship teams. He also found time in between basketball and baseball to earn an

NCAA post-graduate scholarship towards obtaining his master's degree in mathematics which he does at ASU in the off-season.

Even though we often recruit directly against the pros when seeking to get a student, we do lose them often to other schools.

Iowa State has a freshman hurler from Canada who wanted to come west. We couldn't help him out so he went to Iowa State. A good move for him, he made it to the College World Series and went the distance in his first start, eliminating Arizona. Needless to say, we didn't even get to the CWS.

ACTUALLY, I FEEL THAT the recruiting of college baseball players is leveling out nationally. We can see that clearly in our own four team WAC Southern Division.

Bob Leigh is doing a fantastic job for the Lobos; the Gray Fox at Tucson, Frank Sancet and I continually lock horns over the top prospects in our area while Andy Cohen's clubs from El Paso rained havoc on all three of us during this past season.

Nationally, the past two world series show the balance being achieved.

The only repeat team from 1969 was Texas of District 6. The lineups for '69 and '70 show Massachusetts and Dartmouth from District 1, NYU and Delaware from 2, Mississippi and Florida State from 3, Southern Illinois and Ohio from 4, Tulsa and Iowa State from 5, ASU and Arizona from 7 plus UCLA and Southern Cal from 8. Now that's balance.

This puts the pressure squarely on our band of Devils and that "Odd Year Magic." We've won in 1965, '67 and '69 with '71 next. Let's not equalize the books too quickly, fellows, give Number 1 another shot at Omaha!

High & Inside

With Journal Sports Editor LeROY BEARMAN

three of the scholarships I committed are free as the kids have since signed pro contracts.

AS YOU SEE THE BIGGEST worry is to figure out which six kids to take. We usually ask for two recommendations from the pro scouts in the kid's area figuring they've seen him play a time or two and know if he's a college prospect.

We are low pressure in recruiting—I talk to a kid one time. We figure if he contacts us first, he's interested.

Even with this "thorough" system, we have a few sleepers get through. Believe it or not, but old Number 1 wasn't totally aware of Reggie Jackson's great baseball prowess. Kush brought him out strictly for football—that

